

Social & Personality Psychology

*Comprehensive EPPP Preparation Study Guide
For Destynee | Dr. DeDe's Concept List*

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1. Temperament

Definition: Biologically-based individual differences in emotional, motor, and attentional reactivity and self-regulation that are consistent across contexts and stable over time.

Whose Idea: Alexander Thomas & Stella Chess (New York Longitudinal Study)

Three Main Types: - **Easy Child (40%):** Regular, adaptable, positive mood - **Difficult Child (10%):** Irregular, slow to adapt, negative mood - **Slow-to-Warm Child (15%):** Low activity, initial withdrawal, slow adaptation

Goodness of Fit: Match between child's temperament and environmental demands.

Source: Thomas, A., & Chess, S. (1977). *Temperament and development*. Brunner/Mazel.

2. Slow-to-Warm Child

Whose Idea: Thomas & Chess (NYLS)

Definition: A temperament type characterized by low activity level, initial withdrawal from new situations, slow adaptation to change, and mild negative reactions to novel stimuli that gradually become positive with repeated exposure.

Characteristics: - Initially cautious or hesitant - Needs time to warm up - Eventually adapts well - Requires patient, supportive parenting - Moderate in approach/withdrawal

Prevalence: Approximately 15% of children.

Source: Thomas, A., Chess, S., & Birch, H. G. (1968). *Temperament and behavior disorders in children*. New York University Press.

3. Goodness of Fit Model

Definition: The match between a child's temperament and the environmental demands and expectations the child faces.

Whose Idea: Alexander Thomas & Stella Chess

Key Concept: Adjustment depends on how well child's temperament matches parental expectations, parenting style, and environmental demands.

Applications: - Mismatch can lead to behavior problems - Intervention involves modifying environment, not just child - Parent education about temperament

Source: Thomas, A., & Chess, S. (1977). *Temperament and development*. Brunner/Mazel.

4. Child Rearing Styles (Baumrind)

Four Types:

1. Authoritative (BEST OUTCOMES) - High warmth + High control - Reasoning, democratic, clear expectations - Outcome: Competent, self-reliant, high self-esteem

2. Authoritarian - Low warmth + High control - Demanding, punitive, obedience-focused - Outcome: Anxious, less socially skilled, lower self-esteem

3. Permissive/Indulgent - High warmth + Low control - Lenient, few demands, non-punitive - Outcome: Impulsive, low self-regulation, poor academics

4. Uninvolved/Neglectful - Low warmth + Low control - Disengaged, indifferent - Outcome: Poor adjustment, behavior problems

Source: Baumrind, D. (1991). The influence of parenting style on adolescent competence. *Journal of Early Adolescence*.

5. Authoritarian Child Rearing

Definition: Low warmth + High control; demanding, punitive, obedience-focused, strict rules without explanation.

Outcomes: - Anxious, fearful children - Less socially competent - Lower self-esteem - Poorer academic performance - Either rebellious or dependent - Difficulty with autonomy

Contrast with Authoritative: Authoritative combines warmth with reasonable control and reasoning.

Source: Baumrind, D. (1991). The influence of parenting style on adolescent competence. *Journal of Early Adolescence*.

6. Identity Statuses (Marcia)

Whose Idea: James Marcia (based on Erikson)

Four Identity Statuses:

Identity Achievement: Exploration + Commitment - Considered options, made commitments - Healthy adjustment

Identity Moratorium: Exploration + No Commitment - Actively exploring, no decisions yet - Associated with anxiety

Identity Foreclosure: No Exploration + Commitment - Adopted parents'/others' values without exploration - May struggle with later challenges

Identity Diffusion: No Exploration + No Commitment - No direction, may appear apathetic - Least adaptive status

Source: Marcia, J. E. (1966). Development and validation of ego-identity status. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*.

7. Identity Diffusion

Definition: An identity status characterized by lack of exploration of identity alternatives and lack of commitment to a defined identity.

Whose Idea: James Marcia

Characteristics: - No exploration of identity options - No commitment to values, goals, or beliefs - May appear apathetic or disconnected - May experience aimlessness - Different from moratorium (which involves active exploration)

Long-term Outcomes: Poorer adjustment if persists into adulthood.

Source: Marcia, J. E. (1966). Development and validation of ego-identity status. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*.

8. Identity Foreclosure

Definition: Identity status with commitment to values/goals without exploration; adopting others' values without questioning.

Whose Idea: James Marcia

Characteristics: - Made commitments without considering alternatives - Often adopts parents' or authority figures' values - May appear confident but untested - Rigid, conventional

Potential Issues: - Difficulty when values challenged - May experience "crisis" later in life - Less flexible in new situations

Source: Marcia, J. E. (1966). Development and validation of ego-identity status. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*.

9. Identity Moratorium

Definition: Active exploration of identity alternatives without commitment.

Whose Idea: James Marcia

Characteristics: - Currently exploring options - Considering different values/beliefs/goals - Has not yet made commitments - Often associated with anxiety and uncertainty

Typical of: College students, young adults actively questioning.

Outcome: Can lead to healthy identity achievement or problematic diffusion.

Source: Marcia, J. E. (1966). Development and validation of ego-identity status. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*.

10. Adolescent Egocentrism (Elkind)

Whose Idea: David Elkind

Two Components:

1. Imaginary Audience: - Belief of being constantly observed/evaluated by others - Leads to self-consciousness - Explains adolescent concern with appearance

2. Personal Fable: - Belief in one's uniqueness and invulnerability - "No one understands me" - "It can't happen to me" - Explains risk-taking behavior

Source: Elkind, D. (1967). Egocentrism in adolescence. *Child Development*.

11. Emerging Adulthood

Definition: Distinct developmental period (ages 18-25) characterized by identity exploration, instability, self-focus, feeling "in-between," and sense of possibilities.

Five Features: 1. Identity exploration 2. Instability 3. Self-focus 4. Feeling "in-between" 5. Age of possibilities

Whose Idea: Jeffrey Arnett

Cross-cultural: Most evident in industrialized, developed countries where education extends into 20s; less distinct in cultures with early marriage/career establishment.

Source: Arnett, J. J. (2000). Emerging adulthood. *American Psychologist*, 55(5), 469-480.

12. Gender Intensification

Definition: Increased gender stereotyping of attitudes and behavior during adolescence.

When: During adolescence (particularly early adolescence, ages 10-14).

Causes: - Pubertal changes - Increased pressure to conform to gender roles - Dating and romantic relationships - Cognitive changes (understanding gender norms)

Patterns: - Girls become more feminine - Boys become more masculine - Particularly evident in behavior, interests, appearance

Source: Galambos, N. L., et al. (1990). Masculinity, femininity, and sex role attitudes in early adolescence. *Child Development*.

13. Two Self-Conscious Emotions

Shame: - Negative evaluation of **global self** - "I am bad" - Develops ~18-24 months - Associated with withdrawal, helplessness

Guilt: - Negative evaluation of **specific behavior** - "I did something bad" - Develops ~3-6 years - Associated with reparative behavior, empathy

Other Self-Conscious Emotions: Pride, embarrassment, envy.

Source: Lewis, M. (2008). Self-conscious emotions. In M. Lewis et al. (Eds.), *Handbook of emotions* (3rd ed.). Guilford Press.

14. Infantile Amnesia

Definition: Inability to remember events from early childhood (typically before age 3-4).

Explanations: - Brain immaturity (hippocampus, prefrontal cortex) - Lack of developed sense of self - Language development (narrative memory requires language) - Different memory systems - Socio-cultural factors

Reminiscence Bump: Better memory for adolescence/early adulthood events throughout life.

Source: Bauer, P. J. (2007). Recall in infancy. *Current Directions in Psychological Science*.

15. Aggression Types

Reactive (Hostile) Aggression: - Emotional response to perceived threat/frustration - Impulsive, "hot" - Defensive - Associated with emotional dysregulation

Proactive (Instrumental) Aggression: - Goal-directed, planned - "Cold," calculated - Used to obtain desired outcome - Associated with callous-unemotional traits

Relational Aggression: - Harm through relationship damage - Exclusion, rumors, manipulation - More common in girls

Source: Dodge, K. A., & Coie, J. D. (1987). Social information-processing factors in reactive and proactive aggression. *Child Development*.

16. Relational Aggression

Definition: Aggressive behavior intended to harm others through damage to relationships, reputation, or social status.

Examples: - Social exclusion - Spreading rumors - Manipulation of friendships - Giving "silent treatment"

Characteristics: - More common in girls than physical aggression - Can be covert (harder to detect) - Associated with peer rejection and internalizing problems - Increases during middle childhood and adolescence

Outcomes: Depression, anxiety, social withdrawal for both perpetrators and victims.

Source: Crick, N. R., & Grotpeter, J. K. (1995). Relational aggression, gender, and social-psychological adjustment. *Child Development*.

17. Peer Status Categories

Popular Children: Liked by many, disliked by few. Can be prosocial (kind, cooperative) or antisocial (dominant, aggressive but "cool").

Rejected Children: Disliked by many, liked by few. - Aggressive-rejected: hostile, disruptive, poor outcomes (CD, delinquency) - Withdrawn-rejected: shy, timid, poor outcomes (depression, loneliness)

Neglected Children: Neither liked nor disliked; often overlooked. - Long-term outcomes: Loneliness, lower self-esteem than average

Controversial Children: Both liked and disliked; often aggressive but also leaders.

Average Children: Moderate on both liked and disliked dimensions.

Source: Coie, J. D., & Dodge, K. A. (1983). Continuities and changes in children's social status. *Child Development*.

18. Popular Antisocial Children

Definition: Children who are high in social status/popularity but display antisocial behaviors; often aggressive, dominant, but perceived as "cool."

Characteristics: - Physically attractive - Athletic - Risk-taking behavior - Socially skilled at manipulation - May be relationally aggressive

Long-term Outcomes: - Association with deviant peer groups - Increased risk for substance use - Relationship problems - Lower academic achievement - Continued antisocial behavior in some cases

Source: Rodkin, P. C., et al. (2000). Heterogeneity of popular boys. *Developmental Psychology*.

19. Rejected Withdrawn Children

Definition: Children actively disliked by peers who are shy, withdrawn, timid, and socially anxious.

Characteristics: - Low social initiative - Social withdrawal - Anxious, sensitive - May be victimized by peers

Long-term Outcomes: - Depression - Social withdrawal - Loneliness - Internalizing disorders - Low self-esteem - Peer difficulties continue

Contrast with Rejected Aggressive: Aggressive-rejected have externalizing problems; withdrawn-rejected have internalizing problems.

Source: Rubin, K. H., et al. (2009). Social withdrawal and shyness. In K. H. Rubin et al. (Eds.), *Handbook of peer interactions*. Guilford Press.

20. Rejected Aggressive Children

Definition: Children actively disliked by peers who are aggressive, disruptive, and hyperactive.

Characteristics: - High rates of conflict with peers - Disruptive behavior - Hyperactivity - Social skill deficits - Often misread social cues

Long-term Outcomes (Worst prognosis): - Conduct disorder - Delinquency - Antisocial behavior - Substance abuse - Adult criminality - School dropout - Highest risk for externalizing disorders

Source: Coie, J. D., & Dodge, K. A. (1998). Aggression and antisocial behavior. In W. Damon & N. Eisenberg (Eds.), *Handbook of child psychology*. Wiley.

21. Socially Neglected Children

Definition: Children who are neither actively liked nor disliked by peers; they often go unnoticed.

Characteristics: - Low visibility in peer group - May be shy or simply overlooked - Few friends but not actively rejected

Long-term Outcomes: - Loneliness - Lower self-esteem than average children - May develop social skills deficits if pattern continues - At risk for later anxiety/depression

Intervention: May benefit from social skills training and opportunities for positive peer interaction.

Source: Rubin, K. H., et al. (2006). Peer relationships in childhood. In W. Damon & R. Lerner (Eds.), *Handbook of child psychology*. Wiley.

22. Play Types

Parten's Social Play Stages:

1. Unoccupied Play: Not engaged in organized activity.

2. Solitary Play: Playing alone with own toys.

3. Onlooker Play: Watching others play.

4. Parallel Play: Playing beside others with similar toys but not interacting.

5. Associative Play: Playing together with similar activities but no organized goals.

6. Cooperative Play: Playing together with organized goals and rules.

Other Types: - **Sociodramatic Play:** Pretend play with roles (ages 2-5) - **Rough and Tumble:** Play fighting/chasing (peak 7-9 years)

Source: Parten, M. B. (1932). Social participation among pre-school children. *Journal of Abnormal and Social Psychology*.

23. Sociodramatic Play

Definition: Pretend play involving role-playing, imagination, and social interaction with others.

Ages: Emerges around 2-3 years; peaks at 4-5 years.

Benefits: - Language development - Social skills and cooperation - Theory of mind - Self-regulation - Creativity - Emotional expression

Components: - Role-taking - Object substitution - Social interaction - Persistence in pretend scenario

Source: Smilansky, S. (1968). *The effects of sociodramatic play on disadvantaged preschool children*. Wiley.

24. Rough and Tumble Play

Definition: Play fighting, chasing, wrestling that resembles real aggression but is without actual aggression.

Common Age: Peak at 7-9 years (elementary school years).

Characteristics: - Participants are smiling/laughing (not angry) - Mutual enjoyment - Role reversal (taking turns) - Self-handicapping (stronger child holds back)

Functions: - Social bonding - Establishing dominance hierarchies - Practice for real conflict - Physical development

Source: Pellegrini, A. D., & Smith, P. K. (1998). Physical activity play. *Child Development*.

25. Bronfenbrenner's Bioecological Systems

Whose Idea: Urie Bronfenbrenner

Five Systems:

Microsystem: Immediate environments (family, school, peers, church)

Mesosystem: Connections between microsystems (parent-teacher communication, home-school relationships)

Exosystem: External environments affecting child (parent's workplace, school board, neighborhood)

Macrosystem: Cultural values, laws, customs, resources

Chronosystem: Time dimension - ontogenetic time and historical time

Source: Bronfenbrenner, U., & Morris, P. A. (2006). The bioecological model of human development. In W. Damon & R. Lerner (Eds.), *Handbook of child psychology*. Wiley.

26. Mesosystem

Definition: The connections and interactions between different microsystems (settings) in a child's life.

Whose Idea: Urie Bronfenbrenner (Bioecological Systems Theory)

Examples: - Parent-teacher communication - Home-school relationships - Parent-peer connections - School-church connections

Importance: Positive mesosystem connections enhance child development; conflict between microsystems creates stress.

Source: Bronfenbrenner, U. (1979). *The ecology of human development*. Harvard University Press.

27. Chronosystem

Definition: The dimension of time in the bioecological model, including both the timing of developmental events within a person's life and broader historical changes.

Whose Idea: Urie Bronfenbrenner (added in later revisions)

Components: - **Ontogenetic time:** Individual life course development - **Historical time:** Generational/cohort effects - **Timing of events:** Sensitive periods, developmental transitions

Examples: - Divorce timing in child's life - Historical events affecting development - Normative age-graded influences

Source: Bronfenbrenner, U., & Morris, P. A. (2006). The bioecological model. *Handbook of child psychology*. Wiley.

28. Emotion-Centered vs Problem-Centered Coping

Emotion-Centered Coping: - Focuses on managing emotional distress - Used when situation cannot be changed - Examples: Seeking emotional support, positive reframing, acceptance, venting, exercise, relaxation

Problem-Centered Coping: - Focuses on changing the stressful situation - Used when situation is controllable - Examples: Planning, taking direct action, seeking information, removing stressor

Research: Both types are adaptive depending on situational controllability. Best outcomes often involve matching coping to situation.

Source: Lazarus, R. S., & Folkman, S. (1984). *Stress, appraisal, and coping*. Springer.

29. Acculturative Stress

Definition: Psychological impact of adapting to a new culture; stress from cultural differences and adaptation demands.

Manifestations: - Anxiety, depression - Identity confusion - Psychosomatic symptoms - Intergenerational conflict - Academic/occupational difficulties

Acculturation Strategies (Berry): - Integration (maintain heritage + adopt new) - Assimilation (adopt new, abandon heritage) - Separation (maintain heritage only) - Marginalization (neither)

Source: Berry, J. W. (2005). Acculturation: Living successfully in two cultures. *International Journal of Intercultural Relations*.

30. Psychosocial Dwarfism

Definition: Significantly reduced growth and delayed physical development caused by severe emotional deprivation, stress, or abuse, despite adequate nutrition.

Mechanism: Chronic stress elevates cortisol, which suppresses growth hormone secretion.

Characteristics: - Growth failure despite normal nutrition - Often occurs in institutionalized or severely neglected children - Reversible if placed in supportive environment - Associated with behavioral symptoms (withdrawal, apathy)

Also Called: Deprivation dwarfism, stress dwarfism.

Source: Gardner, L. I. (1972). Deprivation dwarfism. *Scientific American*, 227(1), 76-82.

31. Cognitive Development in Adulthood

Postformal Thought: Adult thinking characterized by understanding that knowledge is relative, problems have multiple solutions, and contradictions can be integrated.

Perry's Scheme of Cognitive Development:

Dualism: Knowledge is absolute; single correct answers exist.

Multiplicity: Uncertainty exists, but all opinions equally valid.

Relativism: Knowledge depends on context; evidence-based evaluation.

Commitment: Making choices within relativistic framework.

Source: Perry, W. G. (1970). *Forms of intellectual and ethical development in the college years*. Holt, Rinehart and Winston.

32. Vocational Development

Ginzberg's Stages of Vocational Choice:

Fantasy Period (Ages 4-10): - Unrealistic, imaginative exploration - Based on interests and fantasy - No reality constraints

Tentative Period (Ages 11-17): - Interests-based exploration - Capacity and value considerations - Tentative choices

Realistic Period (Age 17+): - Reality-based decision making - Exploration → Crystallization → Specification

Source: Ginzberg, E., et al. (1951). *Occupational choice: An approach to a general theory*. Columbia University Press.

33. Gender Identity Development

Definition: Deeply-felt sense of being male, female, both, neither, or elsewhere on gender spectrum.

Developmental Timeline: - **Ages 2-3:** Gender identity emerges (label self) - **Ages 3-4:** Gender stability (understand gender stable over time) - **Ages 5-7:** Gender constancy (understand gender stable despite appearance changes)

Gender Typing: Process by which children acquire gender roles.

Biological Theories: Prenatal hormones influence brain development and behavior.

Social Learning: Observation, imitation, reinforcement of gender-appropriate behavior.

Cognitive Theories: Kohlberg's stages; gender schema theory.

Source: APA Guidelines for Psychological Practice with Transgender and Gender Nonconforming People (2015).